

The Reef Watchers: Protecting a Changing Ocean

NAPLAN-Style Informational Reading Worksheet

Year 6 English

ACARA: AC9E6LY03

AC9E6LY05 | AC9E6LY06

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: ____ / 20

Learning Intention: I can analyse an informational text, infer meaning, evaluate evidence and justify my answers using details from the passage.

Reading Strategy**Read like a detective - underline facts, circle key words and use evidence.**

Reading Passage

The Great Barrier Reef is one of Australia's most famous natural wonders. It stretches along the coast of Queensland and is home to thousands of species, including coral, fish, turtles, molluscs and seabirds. To visitors, the reef may look like a bright underwater garden, but it is actually a living system made up of many connected parts.

Coral is often mistaken for rock or colourful seaweed. In fact, coral is made by tiny animals called polyps. These polyps build hard structures that become homes and hiding places for many other marine creatures. When coral is healthy, it supports a wide variety of life. When coral is stressed, the effects can move through the whole ecosystem.

One major concern is coral bleaching. Bleaching can happen when ocean temperatures rise for too long. The coral loses the tiny algae that live inside it and help provide food. Without the algae, the coral turns pale. Bleached coral is not always dead, but it is weaker and needs time to recover. If stressful conditions continue, the coral may not survive.

Scientists are working hard to understand what helps reefs stay resilient. Some teams use underwater cameras, drones and satellite images to monitor changes over time. Others study water quality, storms, crown-of-thorns starfish and the effects of pollution carried from land into the sea. This information helps decision-makers identify where protection is most urgently needed.

Communities also play an important role. Farmers can reduce chemical run-off, tourists can follow reef-safe rules, and families can make choices that reduce waste and energy use. Schools can help by teaching students why the reef matters and how everyday actions connect to larger environmental issues.

Protecting the Great Barrier Reef is not a simple task. It requires science, careful planning and cooperation between governments, researchers, businesses and ordinary people. The reef has faced challenges before, and parts of it can recover when conditions improve. However, its future depends on choices made today. If Australians understand both the beauty and the fragility of the reef, they are more likely to help protect this remarkable living treasure.

Reading Comprehension Questions

Answer from easy to hard. Use evidence from the passage where needed.

Section A Multiple choice

1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

- ☐ To entertain with a fictional adventure ☐ To explain an issue and possible responses
☐ To list random facts ☐ To persuade readers to avoid all technology

Section B Find the facts

2. Identify two facts from the passage that show why the topic matters.

3. Name one person, group or technology involved in solving the problem.

Section C

Vocabulary

4. In the passage, what does 'resilient' most nearly mean?

- ☐ Able to recover or keep going ☐ Completely destroyed
☐ Very noisy ☐ Made from plastic

Author's Purpose

5. Why did the author include specific examples or data in the passage?

Section D Inference

6. What can you infer about why scientists collect long-term reef data?

7. Write one question you still have after reading this text.

- ☐ Evidence used ☐ Key vocabulary ☐ Clear opinion ☐ Capital letters & full stops
☐ Answer checked

High Five! You're a Reading Comprehension Superstar!

☐ Vocabulary ☐ Inference ☐ Evidence Response - All done = Reader Award in Pet Town!

Teacher / Parent Feedback

Well done for...

Next step...

Star Rating: ☆☆☆☆☆

Teacher & Parent Guide

The Reef Watchers: Protecting a Changing Ocean - Year 6 Reading

Curriculum Alignment - ACARA v9.0

AC9E6LY03 - Analyse how text structures and language features work together to meet the purpose of a text.

AC9E6LY05 - Use comprehension strategies to interpret and analyse information and ideas.

AC9E6LY06 - Create written responses using evidence from texts.

Answer Key & Sample Responses

Question	Expected Response / Marking Guide	Marks
1	To explain why the reef is important and how it can be protected.	2
2	Accept facts such as many species live there; coral supports ecosystems; bleaching weakens coral.	4
3	Scientists, governments, farmers, tourists, families or technologies such as drones/cameras.	2
4	Resilient means able to recover or keep going.	1
5	Examples/data make the issue concrete and show why protection is needed.	3
6	They need long-term evidence to notice patterns, compare changes and make better decisions.	4
7	Accept a relevant question connected to reef protection or environmental change.	1

Differentiation Strategies

Support / Foundation

- Read passage aloud
- Highlight key words
- Answer Sections A-B
- Use sentence frames

At Level / Year 6

- Complete all sections
- Use evidence
- Explain vocabulary
- Self-check answers

Extension / Advanced

- Compare with another text
- Research a real example
- Write a balanced response
- Create an infographic

Fun Aussie Activities at Home

Map It

Find the Great Barrier Reef on a map and list three nearby places.

Family Talk

Discuss one action your family can take to reduce ocean pollution.

Mini Research

Research one reef animal and write three facts.

Poster Task

Create a poster explaining why healthy coral matters.